

**Delta Doradus**  
34 Suns

**Alpha Doradus**  
110 Suns

**Beta Doradus**  
2,600 Suns



## KEY DATA

**Size ranking** 72  
**Brightest stars** Alpha (α) 3.3, Beta (β) 3.8  
**Genitive** Doradus  
**Abbreviation** Dor  
**Highest in sky at 10pm** December–January  
**Fully visible** 20°N–90°S



CHART 2

## MAIN STARS

**Alpha (α) Doradus**  
White giant and binary star  
 ☼ 3.3 ↔ 170 light-years

**Beta (β) Doradus**  
Yellow supergiant and Cepheid variable star  
 ☼ 3.5–4.1 ↔ 1,005 light-years

## DEEP-SKY OBJECTS

**NGC 1566**  
Spiral galaxy; also a Seyfert galaxy

**NGC 1672**  
Barred spiral galaxy; also a Seyfert galaxy

**NGC 1850**  
Compact star cluster in the Large Magellanic Cloud

**NGC 1929**  
Star cluster in the Large Magellanic Cloud

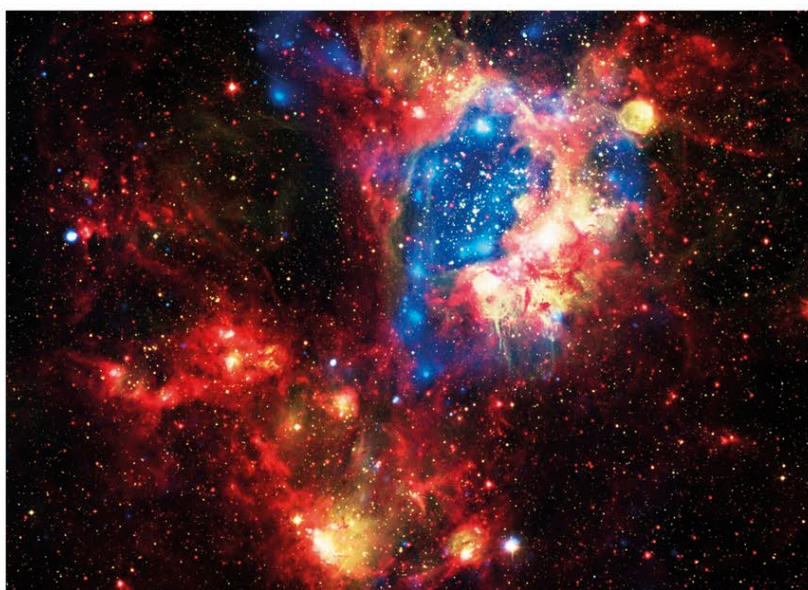
**NGC 2080** (Ghost Head Nebula)  
Star-forming region in the Large Magellanic Cloud

**NGC 2082**  
Barred spiral galaxy

**Large Magellanic Cloud**  
Disrupted barred spiral galaxy

**Tarantula Nebula (30 Doradus)**  
Star-forming region in the Large Magellanic Cloud

**Supernova 1987A**  
Supernova in the Large Magellanic Cloud



### △ Tarantula Nebula

This huge region of star clusters, glowing gas, and dark dust is one of the largest star-forming nebulae known. A bright star (center left) appears to shine in a clearing. This is actually a cluster of stars that is emitting most of the energy that makes the nebula so clearly visible.

### ◁ NGC 1929

Massive stars in the star cluster NGC 1929 expel matter at high speed and explode as supernovae. The supernova shock-waves and winds carve out huge cavities called superbubbles (the blue areas) in the surrounding gas of the N44 nebula.

### ▷ The Large Magellanic Cloud

This satellite galaxy of the Milky Way is about 180,000 light-years away. Once thought to be an irregular galaxy, it is now believed to be a disrupted barred spiral. The red patch (centre right) is the Tarantula Nebula.

